

session hijacking include session fixation, session sniffing, cross-site scripting, brute force, etc.

In the project I am working on currently, we leveraged public key cryptosystem (RSA) and device attestation with FIDO2 specifications to ensure extreme security. However, the cookie hijacking vulnerability was still present and had to be dealt with on the server side. So I decided to use AES 128 to check for duplication of the user's IP address. Unlike the RSA algorithm, AES (advanced encryption standard) requires that both the encryptor and decryptor use the same key, which makes symmetric algorithms much faster than the former. AES includes three block ciphers to encrypt and decrypt blocks of messages. Each cipher encrypts and decrypts data in blocks of 128 bits using cryptographic keys of 128 bits. Among the different modes of AES, we used fernet in CBC (cipher block chaining) mode because our project was auto logging off in one hour. So fernet, being smaller in size, was perfect for our use case and its use in the Flask application is given below.

```
from flask import *
from cryptography.fernet import Fernet
```

```
key = Fernet.generate_key()
f = Fernet(key)
app = Flask(__name__)
```

In the above code, we are importing Flask and fernet. The class helps with encryption and decryption using the keys generated, which contain bytes or string values. This key is an encoded 32-byte key, with which you may decrypt or encrypt messages.

We may test this with the help of a simple HTML page, like the one shown in Figure 1.

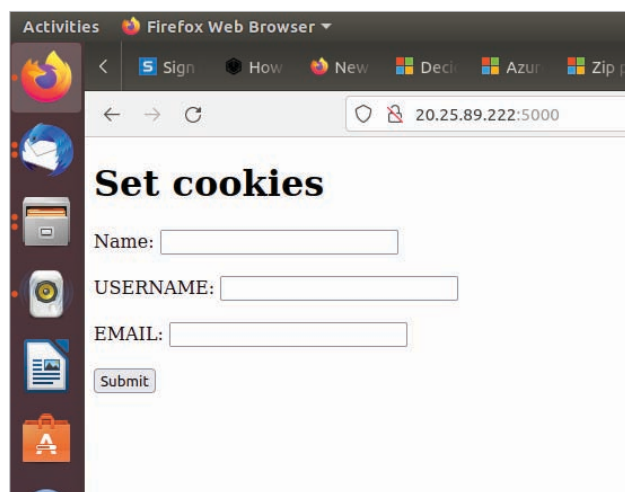


Figure 1: Web page for entering user details

```
@app.route('/login', methods=["GET", "POST"])
def login():
    name=request.form['name'].strip()
    uname=request.form['uname'].strip()
    eml=request.form['eml'].strip()
    k=name+'$'+request.remote_
addr+'$'+uname+'$'+eml
res=f.encrypt(k.encode()).decode()
resp = make_response(redirect('/dashboard'))
resp.set_cookie('username', res, max_age=3600)
return resp
```

In the above code, we are reading from post requests where we get your name, user name and email, and save them after removing spaces.

We can then store the name, IP address, user name and email in the variable *k*, and encrypt it using the generated fernet key.

This gets redirected to the dashboard function. The respective variables containing the encrypted message are set in *cookies* and the maximum age condition is set as 3600.

```
@app.route('/dashboard')
def dashboard():
    username=request.cookies.get('username')
    k=f.decrypt(id.encode()).decode()
    arr=k.split('$')
    name=arr[0]
    ip=arr[1]
    uname=arr[2]
    eml=arr[3]
    if ip==request.remote_addr:
        return render_template('dashboard.html', name=name, uname=
uname, eml=eml)
    else:
        return render_template('error.html', ip=ip, ip1=request.
remote_addr)
app.run()
```

In the dashboard function we decrypt the message from *cookies* and save the data in the respective variables. Next, we check if the IP address provided in the cookie matches the current IP address of the user system. If any case of cookie hijacking is found, you'll see an error page pop up in which the two different IP addresses are displayed and the user gets logged out of the page.

Figure 2 shows the sample page displayed to users after they enter their details. The IP address of the user machine is displayed along with other form details. These details may be misused by gaining unauthorised access to cookie details. In the page shown in Figure 2 we are sending